

LITTLE SPROUT STORIES

Maya & Marcus Visit the Fire Station

A story about feeling nervous — and being brave



Maya and Marcus were on their way to school when something enormous and gleaming stopped them mid-step — a fire truck, red as a ripe apple, parked outside the fire station with its ladders shining in the morning sun. “Whoa,” breathed Marcus. “It’s even bigger up close.”

Maya and Marcus see a big red fire truck.



“Can we look?” Marcus called. The station door rolled up, and out stepped a firefighter with a grin as wide as the doorway. “You sure can,” he said. “I’m Alex. Welcome to our station — would you like to see what a firefighter’s day is really like?”

Alex says, “Come in!”



“Before anything else,” said Alex, “we check our tools — every single morning.” He tested his radio, clicked his flashlight on and off, and lifted the heavy air tank that helps firefighters breathe through smoke. “A firefighter’s first job isn’t fighting fires. It’s making sure everything works before we ever need it.”

Alex checks his tools every day.



Alex showed them the great coiled hoses, thick as tree trunks, and the nozzle that shapes the water into a powerful stream. He let them hold a helmet — surprisingly heavy! — and pointed up at the ladder that could stretch taller than three giraffes. “Every tool has a job,” Alex said, “and we practice until using them feels easy.”

Alex has a hose, a ladder, and a helmet.



Out in the yard, a firefighter was spraying arcs of water at a row of orange cones — splash, splash, splash — knocking them down one by one. “We train even when there’s no fire,” Alex explained, “the way you practice reading even when it’s not a test. When a real emergency comes, our hands already know what to do.”

Firefighters practice to be ready.



Inside, the station smelled of toast and coffee. There was a kitchen with a long table, beds in a quiet room, and a list of chores on the wall — cooking, sweeping, washing the truck. “We live here on our work days,” said Alex, “so the crew becomes like a second family. But even at midnight, we must always, always be ready to go.”

The fire station is like a home.



“The best fire,” Alex told them, kneeling down, “is the one that never starts.” He pressed the button on a smoke alarm — chirp! — and taught them the rules: if the alarm sounds, get out and stay out, and run to your family’s meeting spot. “Part of my job is teaching kids like you, so nobody gets hurt at all.”

If the alarm beeps, go out and stay out.



“Would you like to hear what our fire alarm sounds like?” Alex asked gently. Marcus’s tummy went jumpy, like it was full of bouncing grasshoppers. “It’s loud,” he whispered. “I don’t know if I like loud.”

The bell rings. Marcus feels scared.

How does Marcus feel?

- ◯ Excited
- ◯ Nervous
- ◯ Sleepy



Maya took Marcus’s hand and gave it a warm squeeze. “It’s okay to feel nervous,” she said. Alex nodded kindly. “Here’s our plan: cover your ears first, stand right here beside me, and we’ll count to three together. Brave doesn’t mean not scared. Brave means having a plan — and a friend.”

Maya holds Marcus’s hand. Maya helps Marcus.



Marcus pressed his hands over his ears. “One…” said Alex. “Two…” said Maya. “THREE!” — BRRRING! The alarm sang out, bold and brassy, for one whole second… and then it stopped. Marcus peeked through his fingers. His heart was thumping, but his feet felt steady. “That wasn’t so bad!”

One, two, three! Marcus did it.

How many times did Marcus count?

- ◯ One time
- ◯ Two times
- ◯ Three times



“I did it!” Marcus cheered. Alex laughed. “You know what my favorite part of this job is? It isn’t the truck, and it isn’t the siren. It’s this — helping our town feel safe, and watching somebody discover they’re braver than they thought.” He looked at Marcus. “Somebody like you.”

Marcus did it! Marcus feels glad.



Before they left, Alex lifted them up, up, up into the driver’s seat of the great red truck, where the steering wheel felt as wide as a bicycle tire. Down below, the whole crew waved. Maya and Marcus waved back until their arms ached — two small firefighters-for-a-day, already dreaming of their next visit.

Maya and Marcus clap. “Bye, Alex!”



■ Fire Station Explorer

Great reading!

For Grown-Ups

Feeling/skill: Naming nervousness and using a friend + a plan to move through it.

Ask your child: What do you do when a sound is too loud?

Try this: Count to three while covering your ears, then uncover slowly.

Words to grow on: gleaming, enormous, coiled, stream, practice, emergency, crew, steady, brave. Point at the tools as you name them — hose, nozzle, ladder, air tank, radio, helmet.

The bigger picture: Firefighters do much more than fight fires — they check equipment daily, train constantly, live at the station in shifts, teach fire safety, and keep their community calm and prepared.

Standards: RL.K.1, SL.K.3

The End — thanks for reading!